
University of Dubai – DSS Award Ceremony

Overview

The **DSS Award Ceremony** is an annual celebration organized by the Department of Student Services at the University of Dubai to recognize and reward students and student clubs who have demonstrated excellence, leadership, innovation, service, and commitment throughout the academic year.

Held at the end of the Spring Semester and attended by the university's top management, the ceremony highlights the importance of student engagement in shaping a vibrant campus culture and acknowledges outstanding contributions across multiple areas of university life.

Award Categories

1. Best Club of the Year
2. Presidential Medal for Student Leadership
3. Trophy of High Achievement
4. UD Ambassador Award
5. Outstanding Athlete Award
6. Student Entrepreneur Award

General Conditions for All Awards

- All award recipients must have **no misconduct records** during the **current academic year**.
- For the **Presidential Medal**, the student must have **no record of misconduct at any time** during their academic journey at UD.
- A student may receive **up to two awards**, as long as they are from **different categories**.

1. Best Club of the Year

Overview

Awarded to the club that has demonstrated exceptional performance through organizing high-quality, impactful events that contribute meaningfully to student life.

Eligibility

- Must have organized at least 4 events, excluding Club Fair, National Day, and International Day.
- Total events should collectively serve approximately 250 students.
- Clubs must submit documentation including event reports, feedback records, visuals, and media presence.

Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	Description	Weight
Number of Events Organized	Total number of officially approved events executed by the club (excluding Club Fair, National Day, and International Day).	20%
Engagement & Feedback	Measures both attendance numbers and quality of student interaction. Includes feedback surveys, student comments, or evidence of learning/impact during events.	30%
Team Collaboration & Professionalism	Assesses the club's internal communication, delegation of tasks, member involvement, and event delivery process. DSS may refer to community comments and team consistency.	15%
Innovation & Creativity	Evaluates the originality of event concepts, new formats introduced, and creativity. DSS awards points for initiatives that go beyond routine formats.	10%
Recognition & Awards	Includes internal or external recognition, certificates, or winning "Best Club" titles during events.	10%
Documentation & Visibility	Quality and completeness of post-event reports, social media presence, visuals, and promotional content.	15%
Sponsorship Bonus	+10% bonus if the club successfully secured external sponsorships.	—

Selection Method:

- **60% DSS Evaluation** (from the above criteria)
- **40% Student Vote** (*from shortlisted clubs*)

2. Presidential Medal for Student Leadership

Overview

The highest individual honor awarded to a **maximum of 3 students** who have demonstrated visionary leadership and long-term impact through initiatives that significantly benefit student life. This award can be received **only once** during a student's time at UD.

Eligibility

- Must not have previously received the Presidential Medal
- Must have created and led at least 7 original initiatives (including a maximum of 2 recurring/annual events).
- Led a team of at least 5 students across those initiatives.
- Must be endorsed by at least 40 students (endorsements collected by DSS).
- Enrolled for at least 3 academic terms (summer is not included).
- Must have no misconduct record at any time during university life.
- Must score a minimum of 85% in the final evaluation.

Evaluation Criteria

DSS will evaluate work from the current and previous academic year, covering a total of **2 academic years**.

Criterion	Description	Weight
Number of Original Initiatives	Number of student-led projects that were newly created. DSS must confirm these are not pre-existing events and that each initiative was executed.	25%
Student Impact Score	Measures the significance and relevance of the initiatives on student life. DSS should assess outcomes such as behavioral change, new opportunities, or student feedback.	25%
Leadership Effectiveness	Based on how the student led the team across the initiatives. DSS can refer to community feedback, student testimonials, and evidence of structured teamwork.	20%
Recognition & Endorsements	Includes students' endorsements (collected by DSS), staff recommendations, and faculty support. DSS should verify authenticity and diversity of sources.	15%
Professional Conduct & Commitment	DSS should consider punctuality, initiative, and the student's professionalism throughout the academic year.	15%

Post-Award Status:

Awardees will be promoted to an **honorary role within DSS**, transitioning from recipient to contributor, assisting with future awards and student initiatives.

3. Trophy of High Achievement

Overview

Awarded to the **top 1% of the student population** who have demonstrated exceptional involvement and consistently supported UD events, student clubs, and DSS efforts throughout the academic year.

Eligibility

- Must have supported or organized at least 5 UD events.
- Actively participated in clubs, DSS, or student-led initiatives.
- Endorsed by at least 20 students (collected by DSS).
- No misconduct record during the academic year.

Evaluation Criteria

If the number of eligible students exceeds 1% of the student population, the following criteria will be used to help identify those who best represent the spirit of the award.

Criterion	Description	Weight
Number of Events Participated	Total number of events involved in. DSS should verify through event records, sign-in sheets, and visual documentation.	30%
Events and DSS Support	Evaluates how the student supported event execution—logistics, registration, stage management, etc. DSS should confirm this with club or department leads.	25%
Quality of Engagement	Assesses the level of initiative, support during events, and consistency of performance. DSS can reference peer feedback and stakeholders observations.	20%
Recognition & Endorsements	Includes student's endorsements, official certificates or acknowledgments issued during the academic year.	25%

*DSS may nominate up to **two students for the Trophy of High Achievement** based on observation and internal validation, even without full documentation. This flexible exception ensures recognition of deserving students who have made clear contributions despite incomplete formal submissions.*

4. UD Ambassador

Overview

Awarded to **1% of the student population** who have served as representatives of UD in external forums, conferences, competitions, or volunteer initiatives.

Eligibility

- Must accumulate a minimum of 60 points using the following system:
 - 1 hour of volunteering = 1 point
 - 1 external conference or competition = 10 points
 - Example: 3 conferences + 30 volunteer hours = 60 points
- Must maintain professional and respectful conduct during representation.
- No misconduct record during the academic year.

Evaluation Criteria

If the number of eligible students exceeds 1% of the student population, the following criteria will be used to help identify those who best represent the spirit of the award.

Criterion	Description	Weight
External Participation Score	Calculate the accumulative points collected. DSS verifies with attendance and documentation.	40%
Ambassadorship Quality	Reflects professionalism, initiative, and public conduct. DSS can evaluate based on dress code, communication, and behavior reports from external organizers.	20%
Recognition or Achievements	Includes awards, honors, or speaking roles while representing UD. DSS must confirm these with certificates, programs, or event summaries.	20%
Endorsements & Documentation	DSS should review official letters, photos, and external acknowledgments that confirm the student's active role and representation.	20%

Post-award status: The student will receive an official UD Ambassador badge, which may be worn while representing UD to reflect their status.

*DSS may nominate up to **two students for the UD Ambassador Award** based on observation and internal validation, even without full documentation. This flexible exception ensures recognition of deserving students who have made clear contributions despite incomplete formal submissions.*

5. Outstanding Athlete Award

Overview

Awarded to **5 students** who have demonstrated athletic excellence, discipline, and contribution to UD sports.

Eligibility

- Must have participated in at least 5 official sports competitions.
- Must be a recognized athlete or team member of UD.
- Must not have been dismissed for misconduct or bad behavior during a competition.

Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	Description	Weight
Sports Participation	Number of sport competitions the student was involved in.	30%
Performance & Awards	Based on wins, recognitions, or key contributions. DSS uses coach reports or event result sheets to confirm.	35%
Commitment & Training	DSS should consult training attendance logs and coach feedback to evaluate consistency.	20%
Teamwork & Sportsmanship	DSS considers reports on discipline, collaboration, and team morale from coaches and teammates.	15%

6. Student Entrepreneur Award

Overview

Awarded to **5 students** who have demonstrated outstanding innovation and leadership through a licensed and actively operating business.

Eligibility

- Business/startup must be licensed and legally registered.
- Business/startup must be actively operating for the last 4 months.
- Student must be the founder or a lead partner.
- No misconduct record during the academic year.

Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	Description	Weight
Creativity & Problem Solving	How well does the business idea creatively solve a real-world problem? Does it show originality and clear thinking?	30%
Progress & Operations	Is the business actually running? Are there signs of real progress like a product, service, or customer engagement? (Check websites, social media, etc.)	30%
Leadership & Ownership	Is the student clearly leading the business? Are they taking initiative and making key decisions?	20%
Campus & Community Engagement	Has the student participated in pitch events, student fairs, or received any public recognition or awards?	10%
IEBC Review & Recommendation	The Innovation, Entrepreneurship and Business Center provides its recommendation and feedback on the business.	10%